BONUS · NEUROKIDS

Brain-Stimulating Activities

Challenge your mind with fun puzzles, riddles, and brain games

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Exercise Your Brain!

> *Your brain is like a muscle — the more you use it, the stronger it gets. These activities are designed to give your brain a fantastic workout!*

Welcome to **Brain-Stimulating Activities**, a collection of puzzles, games, and challenges that will stretch your thinking in every direction. Inside these pages, you will find four types of brain workouts:

👁 Visual Puzzles

Train your eyes and spatial awareness with spot-the-difference challenges, mirror drawings, hidden objects, shadow matching, and pattern sequences.

🧠 Logic Games

Sharpen your reasoning skills with deduction puzzles, category sorting, odd-one-out challenges, true-or-false quizzes, and secret code breaking.

📚 Word Games

Boost your vocabulary and language skills with word scrambles, rhyming pairs, compound words, and creative word categories.

🔢 Number Games

Flex your math muscles with number crosswords, magic squares, number sequences, and mystery equation puzzles.

How to Use This Book

Work through the activities at your own pace. Use a pencil so you can erase and try again. There are no time limits — the goal is to think carefully, have fun, and challenge yourself. When you finish all the activities, fill in the **Brain Challenge Certificate** at the end. You earned it!

Difficulty Levels

⭐ = Warm-up ⭐⭐ = Getting Harder ⭐⭐⭐ = Brain Buster!
Look for these stars at the top of each activity to know what to expect.

SECTION 1

Visual Puzzles

Train your eyes to see what others miss. Look closely, compare carefully, and complete the picture!

Spot 10 Differences

> *Read both scene descriptions carefully. They look almost the same, but 10 details have changed. Can you find them all?*

Scene A — The Park on Saturday Morning

Read this scene and picture it in your mind. Then read Scene B and spot what changed.

It is a bright Saturday morning at Riverside Park. A **red** bench sits beside the gravel path, where a woman in a **yellow hat** is reading a thick book. Behind her, **three** ducks glide across the calm pond. Near the playground, a boy in a **striped** shirt is flying a **blue** kite shaped like a diamond. To his left, a girl with **pigtails** is swinging on the **second** swing from the left. Under the tall oak tree, **five red apples** hang from the lower branches. A golden retriever is chasing a **tennis ball** across the grass. The old clock tower at the park entrance shows **3:00**. A bicycle with a **basket** on the front leans against the wooden fence. Near the flower garden, **two** butterflies flutter above the daisies. The ice cream cart has a sign that reads "**Scoops & Smiles**" in blue letters.

Scene B — The Park on Saturday Morning (?)

This scene is almost the same as Scene A — but 10 things are different!

It is a bright Saturday morning at Riverside Park. A **green** bench sits beside the gravel path, where a woman in a **purple hat** is reading a thick book. Behind her, **four** ducks glide across the calm pond. Near the playground, a boy in a **polka-dot** shirt is flying a **red** kite shaped like a diamond. To his left, a girl with **a ponytail** is swinging on the **third** swing from the left. Under the tall oak tree, **three red apples** hang from the lower branches. A golden retriever is chasing a **frisbee** across the grass. The old clock tower at the park entrance shows **5:00**. A bicycle with a **bell** on the front leans against the wooden fence. Near the flower garden, **four** butterflies flutter above the daisies. The ice cream cart has a sign that reads "**Scoops & Smiles**" in blue letters.

Check off each difference you find:

- [ ] Difference 1: _____
- [ ] Difference 2: _____
- [ ] Difference 3: _____
- [ ] Difference 4: _____
- [ ] Difference 5: _____
- [ ] Difference 6: _____
- [ ] Difference 7: _____
- [ ] Difference 8: _____
- [ ] Difference 9: _____
- [ ] Difference 10: _____

Mirror Image Completion ⭐⭐

> *The left half of each shape is drawn for you. Draw the matching right half to complete the mirror image. Use the dotted center line as your guide.*

Shape 1 — Heart

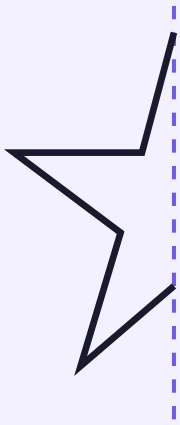
Complete the right half of the heart.



Draw here →

Shape 2 — Star

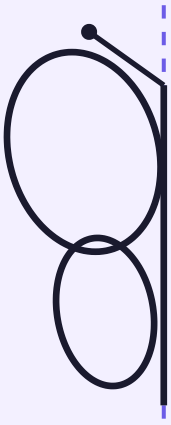
Complete the right half of the star.



Draw here →

Shape 3 — Butterfly

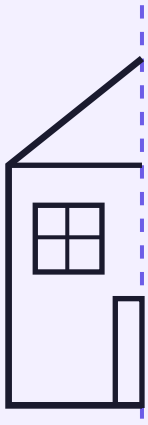
Complete the right half of the butterfly.



Draw here →

Shape 4 — House

Complete the right half of the house.



Draw here →

Hidden Objects ⭐⭐

> *Read the scene description below very carefully. Hidden among the details are 12 special objects. Can you find them all?*

The Busy Kitchen

Read slowly and picture the scene. Each time you spot one of the 12 hidden objects from the checklist, mark it off!

It was Grandma's birthday, and the kitchen was buzzing with activity. Dad stood at the counter rolling out dough with a long wooden **rolling pin**, flour dusting his blue apron. On the windowsill behind him, a small **hourglass** timer counted down the minutes for the cookies already in the oven. Mom was at the stove stirring a big pot of soup, and balanced on her head — just for fun — was a shiny **silver crown** she'd found in the costume box. Little Mia sat at the table with her colored pencils, drawing a picture of a **rainbow** on a sheet of paper, while her baby brother banged a **wooden spoon** on his highchair tray. Tucked between the cookbooks on the shelf, someone had hidden a tiny **rubber duck**. On the fridge door, held up by a **horseshoe magnet**, was a grocery list with the words "Don't forget the candles!" The family cat, Whiskers, napped inside a large **mixing bowl** on the bottom shelf, curled up like a cinnamon roll. Near the back door, a pair of muddy **rain boots** sat next to the mat. Hanging from the light fixture above the table was a single **paper airplane** that someone had launched earlier and never retrieved. Through the open window you could see a **ladybug** crawling along the outside ledge. And right there on the counter, almost hidden under a tea towel, was Grandma's birthday present: a small velvet box containing a **gold locket**.

Find all 12 hidden objects:

- [ ] Rolling pin
- [ ] Hourglass timer
- [ ] Silver crown
- [ ] Rainbow (drawing)
- [ ] Wooden spoon
- [ ] Rubber duck
- [ ] Horseshoe magnet
- [ ] Mixing bowl
- [ ] Rain boots
- [ ] Paper airplane
- [ ] Ladybug
- [ ] Gold locket

Bonus Challenge

Go back and re-read the scene. Can you draw the kitchen from memory, placing each object where it was described?

Shadow Matching

> *Each object on the left has a matching shadow on the right. Draw a line from each object to its correct shadow.*

Match the Object to Its Shadow

The objects are numbered 1–6 on the left. The shadows are lettered A–F on the right, but they are in a different order! Draw a line connecting each number to its matching letter.

Object	Shadow
1. Bicycle — two wheels, handlebars, pedals, a seat	**A.** Round shape with a handle on top and a spout on the side
2. Teapot — round body, curved spout, lid with knob on top, handle	**B.** Long body with four legs, a tail, and two pointed ears
3. Cat — four legs, long tail, pointed ears, whiskers	**C.** Flat base with a cone shape rising to a point, curved brim
4. Guitar — figure-eight body, long neck, tuning pegs at the top	**D.** Two circles connected at the bottom, with bars across the top and two sticks below
5. Witch's hat — wide brim, tall pointed cone	**E.** Narrow shape like a figure eight, with a long thin neck and small bumps at the top
6. Umbrella — dome shape on top, curved handle at the bottom, straight pole	**F.** Half-circle dome on a straight stick with a curved hook at the bottom

Write your answers here:

1 = ____ 2 = ____ 3 = ____ 4 = ____ 5 = ____ 6 = ____

Visual Sequence ★★

Study each pattern carefully. What comes next? Draw or write the missing shape(s) in the empty box(es).

Pattern 1

What shape comes next?



Pattern 2

What two shapes come next?



Pattern 3

What shape comes next?



Pattern 4

What two shapes come next?



Brain Boost Tip

To crack a pattern, ask yourself: “What is the smallest group of shapes that repeats?” Once you find the repeating group, you can predict what comes next!

SECTION 2

Logic Games

Put on your detective hat! These puzzles will test your reasoning, deduction, and critical thinking skills.

Deduction Puzzles ⭐⭐

> *Read the clues for each puzzle carefully. Use logic to figure out who has what. Write your answers on the lines provided.*

Puzzle 1: Three Friends and Their Pets

Alex, Ben, and Cara each have a different pet: a cat, a dog, or a fish. Read the clues and figure out who has which pet.

> **Clues**
>
> - Alex does **not** have a dog.
> - Ben is allergic to cats, so his pet is not a cat.
> - Cara's pet is the biggest of the three.

Answers:

Alex has a _____

Ben has a _____

Cara has a _____

Hint: Think about which pet is the biggest. That narrows things down quickly!

Puzzle 2: Ice Cream Flavors

Dana, Eli, Fay, and Gus each love a different ice cream flavor: chocolate, vanilla, strawberry, or mint. Who loves which flavor?

> **Clues**
>
> - Dana only likes flavors that are **brown or red** (chocolate or strawberry).
> - Eli does **not** like mint.
> - Fay's absolute favorite flavor is **strawberry**.
> - Gus does **not** like chocolate.

Answers:

Dana loves _____

Eli loves _____

Fay loves _____

Gus loves _____

Puzzle 3: Musicians on the Street

Hana, Ivan, and Jill each play a different instrument (piano, guitar, or drums) and each lives on a different street (Oak St., Maple St., or Pine St.).

> **Clues**
>
> - Hana does **not** play drums.
> - The guitar player lives on **Maple Street**.
> - Ivan lives on **Pine Street**.
> - Jill plays the **piano**.

Answers:

Hana plays _____ and lives on _____ St.

Ivan plays _____ and lives on _____ St.

Jill plays _____ and lives on _____ St.

Category Sorting ★★

The 20 words below belong to 4 different categories. Can you figure out the categories and sort every word into the correct column?

Sort These 20 Words

Read all the words first. Then figure out the 4 categories and write each word in the correct column of the table below.

Apple | Tiger | Guitar | Brazil | Banana | Dolphin | Piano

Japan | Grape | Eagle | Violin | Egypt | Mango | Rabbit

Trumpet | France | Kiwi | Whale | Flute | Canada

CATEGORY 1: _____	CATEGORY 2: _____	CATEGORY 3: _____	CATEGORY 4: _____

Strategy Tip

Start by finding two words that obviously belong together. That gives you your first category. Then look for more words that fit the same group. Repeat until all 20 words are sorted!

Which Doesn’t Belong? 

> *In each group of four items, one does not belong with the others. Circle the odd one out and write why it is different.*

Group 1

Apple **Banana** **Carrot** **Orange**

The odd one out is: _____

Because: _____

Group 2

Chair **Table** **Lamp** **Sandwich**

The odd one out is: _____

Because: _____

Group 3

Dog **Cat** **Goldfish** **Oak Tree**

The odd one out is: _____

Because: _____

Group 4

Circle **Square** **Triangle** **Red**

The odd one out is: _____

Because: _____

Group 5

January **Monday** **March** **July**

The odd one out is: _____

Because: _____

True or False Quiz

> *Read each fun fact carefully. Is it TRUE or FALSE? Write **T** or **F** in the box. How many can you get right?*

15 Incredible Facts — or Are They?

Circle or write T (True) or F (False) for each statement.

1.	An octopus has three hearts.	T	F
2.	Venus is the closest planet to the Sun.	T	F
3.	Honey never spoils. Archaeologists have found 3,000-year-old honey that was still edible.	T	F
4.	A group of flamingos is called a “flamboyance.”	T	F
5.	Lightning never strikes the same place twice.	T	F
6.	Bananas grow on trees.	T	F
7.	The Great Wall of China is easily visible from outer space with the naked eye.	T	F
8.	Sharks have been on Earth longer than dinosaurs.	T	F
9.	Humans share about 60% of their DNA with bananas.	T	F
10.	The color orange was named after the fruit, not the other way around.	T	F
11.	Sound travels faster through water than through air.	T	F
12.	An adult human body has 206 bones.	T	F
13.	Penguins can fly short distances when they are scared.	T	F
14.	A snail can sleep for up to three years.	T	F
15.	The Moon produces its own light, just like the Sun.	T	F

My score: _____ out of 15

Code Breaking ★★★

> *Use the secret cipher key below to decode the hidden messages. Each number stands for a letter of the alphabet!*

The Secret Cipher Key

A = 1, B = 2, C = 3 ... all the way to Z = 26. Use this key to decode the messages below.

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16

Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

Message 1

`25 - 15 - 21  1 - 18 - 5  1 - 23 - 5 - 19 - 15 - 13 - 5`

Decoded: _____

Message 2

`2 - 18 - 1 - 9 - 14  16 - 15 - 23 - 5 - 18`

Decoded: _____

Message 3

`14 - 5 - 22 - 5 - 18  7 - 9 - 22 - 5  21 - 16`

Decoded: _____

Message 4

`11 - 14 - 15 - 23 - 12 - 5 - 4 - 7 - 5  9 - 19  6 - 21 - 14`

Decoded:

Message 5

`20 - 8 - 9 - 14 - 11  2 - 9 - 7`

Decoded:

SECTION 3

Word Games

Words are building blocks for thinking! Unscramble, match, rhyme, and play your way to a bigger vocabulary.

Word Scrambles 

> *The letters of each word have been mixed up. Unscramble them and write the correct word on the line. All 20 words are things you might find in an adventure story!*

1. **ZZLEPU** _____
2. **BOWNIAR** _____
3. **NETLAP** _____
4. **CKRTOE** _____
5. **TTBUEYFLR** _____
6. **NCOEA** _____
7. **PHOLIND** _____
8. **GNRDAO** _____
9. **STLCAE** _____
10. **GLNUEJ** _____
11. **RTAEIP** _____
12. **GKNHIT** _____
13. **VCLOANO** _____
14. **CMPOSSA** _____
15. **ENPGINU** _____
16. **SLCRTYA** _____
17. **TRONMSE** _____
18. **BLTANKE** _____
19. **GEMTAN** _____
20. **SLNAID** _____

My score: _____ out of 20

Rhyming Word Pairs 

> *For each word below, write a word that rhymes with it. There are many possible answers — try to come up with ones your friends might not think of!*

Find a Rhyming Partner

Write one word that rhymes with each word on the left. The first one is done for you as an example.

#	WORD	RHYMES WITH	BONUS: ONE MORE RHYME!
0.	**Cat**	*Hat* (example)	
1.	**Moon**		
2.	**Tree**		
3.	**Night**		
4.	**Cake**		
5.	**Ring**		
6.	**Boat**		
7.	**Star**		
8.	**Fox**		
9.	**Fly**		
10.	**Train**		
11.	**House**		
12.	**Clock**		

> **Rhyme Challenge**
>
> Can you find a word that rhymes with **orange**? It's one of the hardest words in English to rhyme! (Hint: look up "door hinge"...)

Compound Word Matching

A compound word is made by joining two smaller words together. Match each word on the left with a word on the right to create 12 compound words.

Build 12 Compound Words

Draw a line from each word in Column A to its partner in Column B. Then write the compound word on the line next to it. The first one is done for you.

COLUMN A

1. Sun → __flower__ = __Sunflower__
2. Rain → _____ = _____
3. Foot → _____ = _____
4. Book → _____ = _____
5. Air → _____ = _____
6. Water → _____ = _____
7. Cup → _____ = _____
8. Tooth → _____ = _____
9. Fire → _____ = _____
10. Snow → _____ = _____
11. Bed → _____ = _____
12. Hand → _____ = _____

COLUMN B (SCRAMBLED!)

cake ball bow plane

fly room brush shake

worm fall flower flake

Word Categories 

> *How quickly can you think of 5 things that fit each category? Fill in the lines as fast as you can!*

1. Name 5 things that are RED

2. Name 5 things that have WHEELS

3. Name 5 things that are COLD

4. Name 5 things you find at SCHOOL

5. Name 5 things that can FLY

6. Name 5 things that live in WATER

7. Name 5 things that are ROUND

8. Name 5 things you WEAR on your feet

SECTION 4

Number Games

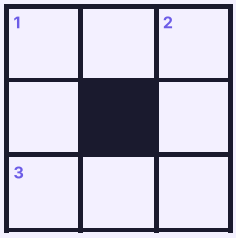
Numbers are everywhere, and they love to play! Crack these codes, fill in the grids, and discover hidden patterns.

Number Crossword

Solve the math clues and fill each digit into the correct cell of the grid. Each answer is a 3-digit number — one digit per cell!

Grid

The grid is 3 rows × 3 columns. The center cell (row 2, column 2) is blacked out. Fill in the remaining 8 cells with digits.



ACROSS

1. **1-Across** (Row 1, all 3 cells): How many days are in one year? *(not a leap year)*
2. **3-Across** (Row 3, all 3 cells): 500 − 11 = ?

DOWN

1. **1-Down** (Column 1, all 3 rows): The first three digits of pi (π) written without the decimal point (3.14... → ___)
2. **2-Down** (Column 3, all 3 rows): 23 × 23 = ?

Hint

Start with the clue you are most sure about. Fill in those digits first. That gives you some digits for the crossing answers!

Magic Squares ★★★

In a magic square, every row, every column, and both diagonals add up to the same number. Fill in the empty cells to complete each magic square!

Magic Square 1

Use the numbers 1–9. Every row, column, and diagonal must add up to **15**.

2		6
9		1
	3	

Target sum: **15**

Magic Square 2

Use the numbers 1–9. Every row, column, and diagonal must add up to **15**.

8		6
	5	
	9	

Target sum: **15**

Magic Square 3 — Extra Challenge!

This one gives you fewer numbers to start with. Use the numbers 1–9. Every row, column, and diagonal must add up to **15**.

6		
	5	
		4

Target sum: **15** — Hint: 5 always goes in the center of a 3×3 magic square!

How Magic Squares Work

In a 3×3 magic square using the numbers 1 through 9, the "magic sum" is always 15. That is because 1+2+3+4+5+6+7+8+9 = 45, and 45 ÷ 3 rows = 15 per row. The number 5 always sits in the center!

Number Sequences 

Each row follows a hidden rule. Figure out the pattern and fill in the missing numbers!

Find the Pattern

Write the next number(s) on each line. Then describe the rule you discovered.

#	SEQUENCE	NEXT	RULE
1.	2, 4, 6, 8, ___, ___		
2.	5, 10, 15, 20, ___, ___		
3.	1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, ___, ___		
4.	3, 6, 9, 12, ___, ___		
5.	100, 90, 80, 70, ___, ___		
6.	1, 4, 9, 16, 25, ___		
7.	2, 6, 18, 54, ___		
8.	1, 2, 4, 7, 11, 16, ___		
9.	1, 3, 7, 15, 31, ___		
10.	10, 8, 11, 9, 12, 10, ___		

Stuck on #3?

This is a very famous sequence! Try adding the two most recent numbers together to get the next one. It was discovered by an Italian mathematician named Fibonacci over 800 years ago.

Stuck on #6?

Try this: 1×1 = 1, 2×2 = 4, 3×3 = 9 ... Do you see the pattern now?

Math Puzzles ★★

Each equation has a missing number. Figure out what goes in the blank to make the equation true!

Find the Missing Number

Write the correct number in each blank box. Show your work in the space beside it if you need to.

1. ☐ + 5 = 12
2. 3 × ☐ = 15
3. 20 − ☐ = 8
4. ☐ × 4 = 36
5. 45 ÷ ☐ = 9
6. 15 + ☐ = 23
7. ☐ × 6 = 42
8. 100 − ☐ = 37

Pro Tip: Working Backwards

If you see ___ + 5 = 12, think: “What number plus 5 gives me 12?” You can also rearrange it: 12 − 5 = ___. For multiplication, use division: if 3 × ___ = 15, then 15 ÷ 3 = ___.

Bonus Round

Try making up your own missing-number equations and quiz a friend or family member!

Brain Challenge Certificate

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

🏆 Brain Champion 🏆

This certifies that

NAME

has successfully completed all of the **Brain-Stimulating Activities** in this book, demonstrating outstanding skills in visual puzzles, logical reasoning, word games, and number challenges.

DATE

⭐ Outstanding Brain Power! ⭐

NeuroKids™

Brain Champion!

Next Step

Congratulations on completing every activity in this book! Your brain is stronger, sharper, and more creative than when you started. But the fun does not stop here — brain games are everywhere once you know how to look.

Try creating your own puzzles for friends and family. Invent a new code, design a pattern sequence, or write tricky true-or-false questions. Teaching others is one of the best ways to keep your brain growing!

Keep thinking. Keep playing. Keep growing.